UNITED KINGDOM — POSITION PAPER

United Nations Model United Nations (MUN) Simulation | Delegate: Ihsan Ali Rind

Agenda: Addressing Climate Change: Global Challenges, Environmental Protection, and Sustainable Solutions

1. Introduction to the Issue

The United Kingdom recognizes climate change as one of the most serious challenges facing the world. Rising temperatures, floods, heatwaves, droughts and rising sea levels threaten human health, food security, economic stability and the environment. The UK believes that climate change requires urgent international cooperation because no country can solve this problem alone.

2. Position and Key Considerations

The United Kingdom supports the Paris Agreement and efforts to limit global warming to 1.5°C. It has a legally binding net-zero greenhouse gas emissions target for 2050 under the Climate Change Act 2008. The UK has also set a target to reduce emissions by at least 81% by 2035 compared with 1990 levels. The UK believes countries should cooperate according to their capabilities, while developed nations should help vulnerable countries through climate finance, technology and technical assistance.

3. Past and Present Situation

Past: The Industrial Revolution began in Britain, and industrial growth increased the use of fossil fuels. The UK has also experienced serious flooding and heatwaves, including the 2007 floods and the July 2022 heatwave, when 40.3°C was recorded at Coningsby.

Present: Climate risks include extreme heat, heavy rainfall, flooding, water stress and coastal impacts. The Met Office reported that 2025 was the warmest year in the UK record beginning in 1884; this report was published on 15 July 2026.

4. International Agreements and Efforts

The UK supports the Paris Agreement (2015), the Glasgow Climate Pact at COP26 (2021), the UN climate process under the UNFCCC, and Sustainable Development Goal 13. The Climate Change Act 2008 provides the legal framework for the UK's emissions targets.

5. Proposed Recommendations

- Encourage stronger national plans to reduce greenhouse gas emissions.
- Expand renewable energy, including wind and solar power.
- Improve climate finance and technical support for developing countries.
- Protect forests, restore ecosystems and conserve biodiversity.
- Strengthen early-warning systems and disaster preparedness.
- Promote climate education and sustainable agriculture.

Conclusion

The United Kingdom believes that climate change is a shared responsibility requiring immediate international cooperation. The UK remains committed to net zero by 2050 and supports practical global action through cooperation, innovation and sustainable development.